

Life on Zephyria

Flora, Fauna, and the Dominant Civilization

Flora

Luminar Trees

The most iconic plant of Zephyria, Luminar Trees grow up to 60 meters tall with bioluminescent leaves that glow in shades of violet and gold at night. They photosynthesize using both visible and ultraviolet light from the binary star system. Luminar forests cover 40% of Valdris and serve as the primary habitat for hundreds of species.

Azure Moss

A ubiquitous ground cover found on all continents, Azure Moss forms dense mats of brilliant blue-green that retain moisture during dry seasons. Zephyrian ecologists consider it the planet's 'biological glue' — preventing soil erosion and anchoring entire ecosystems.

Crystalline Kelp

In the deep oceans, Crystalline Kelp grows in vast submarine forests reaching 200 meters. Its cell walls incorporate silicate compounds, giving it a glass-like appearance. It is the foundation of Zephyria's marine food web and is harvested by the Velorians as a food source.

Whisper Vines

Found in the cave systems of Umbraxis, Whisper Vines are chemosynthetic — deriving energy from mineral-rich hydrothermal vents rather than sunlight. They are believed to form a rudimentary chemical signalling network spanning kilometers.

Fauna

Skyweavers

Six-winged aerial creatures resembling a cross between a manta ray and a jellyfish, Skyweavers glide on thermal currents at altitudes up to 5,000 meters. They are filter feeders, consuming atmospheric spores and microorganisms. Their wingspan can reach 4 meters. Skyweavers migrate between continents seasonally and are considered sacred by the Velorian people.

Thornbacks

Large hexapedal land animals resembling a rhinoceros crossed with an armadillo. Thornbacks have six legs, a heavily armoured carapace covered in crystalline spines, and a highly developed sense of electromagnetic fields, which they use for navigation and communication. They are herbivores weighing up to 3,000 kg.

Glowfish

The seas of Zephyria teem with Glowfish — schooling bioluminescent organisms that communicate through complex light patterns. Researchers have decoded over 200 distinct 'phrases' in their light language, suggesting a rudimentary form of social communication. They are the primary prey of the ocean's apex predators, the Leviathans.

Leviathans

The apex marine predators of Zephyria, Leviathans are enormous eel-like creatures reaching 50 meters in length. Despite their fearsome size, they are highly intelligent, exhibiting cooperative hunting strategies and apparent play behaviour. Their calls, transmitted through the water at sub-sonic frequencies, can travel thousands of kilometres.

Micro-Symbiotes

Microscopic organisms that live in symbiosis with most large Zephyrian animals, Micro-Symbiotes reside in specialized organs and assist with digestion, immune function, and even cognition. The Velorians have a uniquely dense population of neural micro-symbiotes, which some researchers believe contribute to their remarkable memory and pattern recognition abilities.

The Velorians – Zephyria's Dominant Species

The Velorians are the sentient, technologically advanced civilization of Zephyria. Bipedal and bilaterally symmetrical, they share a superficial resemblance to humans but differ significantly in biology, culture, and cognition.

Biology

Velorians stand 1.6–2.1 meters tall, with slender builds and four-fingered hands. Their skin tones range from deep indigo to pale silver, depending on continental origin. They possess four eyes — two forward-facing for depth perception and two lateral for a near-360° field of view. Their auditory range extends into infrasound, allowing them to perceive the planetary rumbles that precede earthquakes. Average lifespan is 180 Zephyrian years (~191 Earth years).

Cognition and Communication

Velorian cognition is characterized by exceptional pattern recognition and distributed memory — they experience memories as vivid, multi-sensory re-livings rather than passive recollections. Their primary language, Veloric, is tonal and partially electromagnetic; Velorians possess bio-electric organs near their temples that transmit emotional nuance alongside spoken words. A Velorian 'conversation' therefore carries layers of meaning inaccessible to external observers.

Society and Culture

Velorian society is organized into Resonance Circles — communities of 200–500 individuals bound by shared values rather than family ties. Decision-making is consensus-based, facilitated by dedicated mediators called Harmonists. Art, music, and memory-sharing (direct experience transmission via neural micro-symbiote networks) are the pillars of Velorian cultural life. War has been absent from Zephyria for over 600 Velorian years.

Technology

The Velorians achieved spaceflight 300 years ago and have established research stations on all three moons. Their energy infrastructure is entirely renewable — tidal, geothermal, and solar. They have not yet developed faster-than-light travel, making contact with Earth purely observational (via deep-space transmission). Their computing architecture is bio-integrated, using engineered micro-symbiote colonies as living processors.